

Celebrating 2026 World Environment Day



BECAUSE THERE IS **NOPLANETB**

From Waste to Resource:
Art that Changes Perspectives



Norwegian Embassy
Abuja



NIKE ART
GALLERY
ABUJA



Workshop Participants during the Road Walk Community Sensitization

Celebrating 2026



World Environment Day

FRIDAY 5TH JUNE, 2026



Nike Art Gallery and Workshops
KILOMETER 7.5 AIRPORT ROAD BY MRS FILLING STATION,
PIWOYI, ABUJA FCT.

Proudly Sponsored by:



**Norwegian Embassy
Abuja**

Partners:



**NIKE ART
GALLERY
ABUJA**

YDSTU
YUSUF DURODOLA STUDIO



This catalogue was published on the occasion of the exhibition
BECAUSE THERE IS NO PLANET B at the
NIKE ART GALLERY AND WORKSHOP, ABUJA.

June 5th, 2026 (World Environment Day)

Copyright © 2026

**NORWAGIAN EMBASSY, ABUJA
NIKE ART GALLERY, ABUJA**

ISBN: 978-978-68-8003-7

Organizing Committee

Solveig Andresen
Lavender Onyenah
Ingrid Rollag Fosker
Yusuf Durodola
Katurag Chinyio
Abdullahi Ibrahim

Workshop Team:

Yusuf Durodola
Lead Facilitator/Director
Temitope Oladeji
Co-Facilitator/Coodinator
Caroline Useh
Co-Facilitator

Curation:

Yusuf Durodola
Temitope Oladeji
Katurag Chinyio

Graphics/Layout:

Abdullahi Ibrahim
Yusuf Durodola

Art Installation:

YD Studio, Lagos
The Art Exential, Lagos

Media Team:

Edge Media

Photography (Performance):

Benjamin Oladapo

Published by:

Integral Visual Ltd.
3, Irewunmi Badru St. Ikorodu, Lagos.

*All rights reserved. No part of this publication
maybe reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or
transmitted in any form or by any means
(electronic, photocopying, recording or otherwise)
without prior written permission of both the
copyright owner and the publisher*



Royal Norwegian Embassy Abuja Crew Visitation

Contents

Forward	08
Gallery Statement	10
Workshop Director's Note	13
Facilitator's Note	14
Workshop Exhibits	16
Panelists	41
About RNE, Nigeria	44
About Nike Gallery	44







H. E. Mr. Svein Baera

*Ambassador
Norwegian Embassy in Abuja
Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Norway*



Ms. Solveig Andresen

*Counselor, Trade and Cultural Affairs
Norwegian Embassy in Abuja
Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Norway*

Forward

This catalogue presents a collection of works created through the workshop “From Waste to Resource: Art that Changes Perspectives.” The pieces reflect the power of artistic expression to re-imagine materials, challenge assumptions, and open new ways of thinking about the world around us.

The workshop was made possible through a valued collaboration between the Royal Norwegian Embassy in Abuja and Nike Art Gallery. We are proud and deeply grateful for this partnership, which brings together artistic excellence and a shared commitment to sustainability.

In Norway, climate and environmental issues are high on the agenda. Through support from the Norwegian government, the Embassy has been able to contribute to initiatives such as this highlighting the importance of cooperation across borders and sectors. Addressing today's environmental challenges requires engagement at all levels: global, international, and local.

The works in this catalogue are a reminder that solutions can emerge from creativity and collaboration. They encourage us to rethink what we consider waste, and to recognize the potential for transformation and renewal.

Ultimately, they also remind us of a simple truth: **we share one planet.** Our future depends on how we care for it together.





GalleryStatement

We extend our heartfelt appreciation to the Royal Norwegian Embassy for sponsoring and bringing together the Upcycle Workshop and Exhibition in celebration of World Environment Day. This remarkable initiative reflects a shared

commitment to environmental sustainability and the transformative power of art.

We are equally grateful to be hosting this project and providing a platform for artists to explore creative solutions to environmental challenges.

Encouraging young artists to embrace recycling and upcycling as artistic practices has always been a core part of the gallery's vision, fostering innovation while promoting environmental responsibility.

Yusuf Durodola's wealth of experience, artistic excellence, and leadership as the lead facilitator played a pivotal role in shaping this workshop alongside the co facilitators...they turned this experience into a truly inspiring showcase.

This project has also created an important opportunity for artists from diverse specializations to engage with new materials, techniques, and forms of artistic expression.

Through collaboration, experiments, and creativity, the exhibition demonstrates how discarded materials can be transformed into works of beauty, meaning, and environmental advocacy.

We celebrate all participating artists, facilitators, and supporters whose dedication and creativity have given birth to this wonderful exhibition. May this initiative continue to inspire greater awareness of sustainable practices and the role of art in creating a healthier environment for future generations.

We believe that through this exercise, more artists and individuals alike will begin to see discarded materials not as waste, but as valuable mediums for creative expression. By transforming trash into art, we not only create beauty and meaning but also contribute to reducing environmental pollution and promoting a cleaner, healthier planet.

We encourage institutions, organizations, communities, and individuals to embrace the culture of turning trash into treasure.

Through collective action, creativity, and innovation, we can inspire sustainable practices that benefit both our environment and future generations. This noble gesture will undoubtedly inspire other bodies and institutions to pursue meaningful collaborations that enable us to identify, nurture, and harness the rich potentials within our communities.

Chief Mrs. Nike Okundaye Dr. Arts (h.c.)
Founder/Director, Nike Art Gallery/Foundation



UPCYCLING ART WORKSHOP

WITH **YUSUF DURODOLA**

Celebrating 2026 World Environment Day

MEET THE TEAM



Yusuf Durodola
LEAD FACILITATOR/WORKSHOP DIRECTOR



Katurag Chinyio
ASST. WORKSHOP DIRECTOR



Temitope Oladeji
CO-FACILITATOR/ WORKSHOP COORDINATOR



Caroline Useh
CO-FACILITATOR



Abdullahi Ibrahim
LOGISTICS COORDINATOR

UPCYCLING ART AS A CREATIVE RESPONSE TO ENVIRONMENTAL CONSCIOUSNESS

"Bi ilu baa baje, ti onilu lo n da."

When the community falls into disrepair, its restoration lies in the hands of those who inhabit it.

In an age increasingly defined by environmental concerns and the consequences of excessive consumption, upcycling art has emerged as a compelling creative response to ecological consciousness. By transforming discarded and overlooked materials into meaningful works of art, artists challenge conventional perceptions of waste and reveal the hidden potential embedded within society's excesses.

More than a process of material reuse, upcycling represents a philosophy of transformation and renewal. Through the imaginative manipulation of plastics, metals, textiles, paper, and other abandoned objects, artists breathe new life into what was once considered worthless. In doing so, they create visual narratives that address issues of pollution, sustainability, and humanity's relationship with the natural world.

Upcycling art occupies a unique space where aesthetics and environmental stewardship converge. It encourages viewers to rethink patterns of consumption and

recognize that creativity itself can become an instrument for ecological awareness. By reimagining the purpose of discarded materials, artists demonstrate that value is not determined by the cost of resources but by the power of vision and innovation.

Beyond its environmental significance, upcycling art fosters education, community engagement, and social responsibility. It inspires individuals and communities to see waste not as an end, but as the beginning of new possibilities. In this sense, the artist becomes both a creator and a custodian, using visual language to advocate for a more conscious and sustainable future.

Ultimately, upcycling art stands as a testament to the transformative power of creativity. It reminds us that beauty can emerge from neglect, that value can be rediscovered in the discarded, and that through imagination and responsibility, art can become a catalyst for environmental consciousness and positive change. In a world where there is no Planet B, the restoration of our environment, much like the Yoruba proverb suggests, rests in our collective hands.



Yusuf Durodola

Lead Facilitator/Workshop Director,
Upcycling Art Workshop 2026





served as a representative of Nike Art Gallery in my capacity as Information Technology Manager for the “There Is No Planet B” Upcycling Art Workshop and Exhibition, sponsored by the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Abuja in collaboration with the Nike Art Gallery, Abuja. In this role, I developed and managed the participant registration system, coordinated data collation and screening processes with the selection team, and designed key administrative and communication materials, including promotional designs, attendance records, and feedback forms. I also provided logistical coordination support to ensure the smooth execution of daily workshop activities.

Beyond my administrative and technical contributions, I remained present throughout the five-day workshop, engaging closely with the creative process from conception to execution. This proximity offered valuable insight into how participating artists transformed discarded materials into meaningful works of art, reinforcing the importance of structured support systems in enabling successful artistic collaboration and production within a sustainable art practice.

I express sincere appreciation to the Royal Norwegian Embassy for their generous sponsorship, Mama Nike for partnering and hosting the programme, the facilitators for their guidance, my colleague Ms. Katurag Chinyio for her collaboration, and all the participating artists for their creativity and commitment throughout the workshop.

Abdullahi Ibrahim

IT Manager/Logistics Coordinator

“Nothing is truly waste until
it is wasted by human
consciousness. To save the earth
is not an option, it is a shared
responsibility.”

-Yuusuf Durodola





The Upcycling Art Project, a collaboration between the Royal Norwegian Embassy and Nike Art Gallery, brought together 15 artists from diverse backgrounds to transform discarded materials into meaningful works of art under the guidance of Mr. Yusuf Durodola.

More than an art workshop, the project promoted environmental awareness by encouraging participants

and communities to see waste as a resource rather than "trash". Through creativity and innovation, "trash" was transformed into treasure, reinforcing the message that we all have a role to play in protecting our environment because there is no Planet B.

I extend my sincere appreciation to the Royal Norwegian Embassy for initiating and supporting this Upcycle Art Workshop, and to Chief Nike Okundaye for generously providing Nike Art Gallery as the venue for both the workshop and exhibition. This collaboration created a memorable and impactful experience for everyone involved.

My gratitude also goes to Mr. Durodola and the co-facilitators for their guidance, patience, and dedication throughout the programme. I acknowledge the commitment of all the participants whose effort, creativity, and perseverance shaped the success of the workshop, as well as Mr. Abdullahi and the behind-the-scenes team for their support. Special thanks to Edge Media and NTA for documenting the entire process.

Katurag Chinyio

Asst. Workshop Director

Facilitator's Note

Art has the power to change how we see the world. Here, it shows us how to modify the world around us.

Over the past week, 15 selected artists came together in Abuja for hands-on *Upcycling Art Workshop*, sponsored by the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Abuja in partnership with the Nike Art Gallery, Abuja, and Yusuf Durodola Studio, Lagos. What began as discarded materials laying fallow around us, have been transformed into powerful works of Art that speaks to sustainability, creativity, and collective responsibility.

The lead facilitator, Yusuf Durodola gave an intense lecture on the Understanding Upcycling Art and Environmental Consciousness while Caroline Useh, a co-facilitator engaged in an educative interaction on the Transition in Creative Process.

As a co-facilitator/workshop coordinator, I led a dedicated session titled **“The Art of Business, The Business of Art”**, exploring how artists can build sustainable practices, navigate markets, positioning, and protect the value of their work in Nigeria's evolving creative economy. The goal was to ensure that beyond the making, these artists leave with practical nuggets to thrive professionally.

This exhibition, hosted by Nike Gallery Abuja, commemorates World Environment Day 2026.

Each piece on display is more than an Artwork—it is a statement. The artists have taken waste and given it new



meaning. We are grateful to the Royal Norwegian Embassy for championing this initiative, to Nike Art Gallery for providing a space for learning and showing these works. May these works inspire dialogue, action, and a renewed commitment to protecting our environment.

Temitope Oladeji

Co- Facilitator/Workshop Coordinator
Upcycling Art Workshop 2026



WORKSHOP

EXHIBITS





Udie Undie

+234 806 240 3121



The five-day “There is No Planet B” Upcycling Art Masterclass marked a significant turning point in my creative journey. I sincerely appreciate the Royal Norwegian Embassy for the sponsorship, Nike Art Gallery Abuja for hosting, and the facilitators—Yusuf Durodola, Caroline Ueshi, and Oladeji Temitope—for their guidance and support throughout the programme.

This experience led to the creation of my mixed-media relief sculpture, “Reframing Rubbish,” which is made entirely from discarded plastics, drink cans, and electrical wires. The work challenges the perception of waste by transforming it into a meaningful visual form, encouraging viewers to reconsider the hidden value in materials often thrown away.

Ultimately, the piece serves as a reminder of our responsibility toward environmental care and sustainable living. It reinforces the importance of initiatives like this masterclass in empowering artists to use creativity as a tool for ecological awareness and positive change.

REFRAMING RUBBISH

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



Ajayi Elijah Snoz

+234 706 803 6606



The “Because There Is No Planet B” Upcycling Workshop was an inspiring experience that reshaped my understanding of how art can communicate environmental messages. Working with fellow creatives helped me discover new ways of turning discarded materials into meaningful expressions. The workshop reinforced my belief that creativity can challenge perspectives, promote awareness, and encourage people to take greater responsibility for the environment.

My artwork uses an eye created from discarded plastics, electronic components, and reclaimed materials to represent awareness and humanity's relationship with nature. The damaged watch within the piece symbolises the urgency of addressing environmental issues before it is too late. By transforming waste into art, I aim to show that discarded materials still have value and can be renewed. I appreciate the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery, the partners, facilitators, and fellow participants for creating a platform that celebrates sustainability, creativity, and positive change.

THE WATCHFUL EYE

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



**Abel Naomi
Ufedo-Ojo**

+234 708 900 5083



The workshop for me, is a real journey. Being surrounded by other artists, I felt a spark of inspiration that changed how I see the world around me. We didn't just sit in a classroom, we were taught to see potential in things that most people throw away. It was a beautiful and shared experience of turning forgotten scraps into something meaningful "from trash to treasure" as our facilitator Mr Yusuf would say.

My piece, the "Survival Spoon," tells a heavy but hopeful story. It represents the children who never get the chance to be children, those who must work just to find their next meal. Using the burnt papers, drink cans, and discarded plastic, this art piece shows that even when a child is forced to fend for themselves in a harsh world, there is still a quiet, stubborn strength. The spoon they hold isn't just for eating; it is their only tool for survival in a world that often ignores their struggle.

I am deeply grateful to the Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery and the partners for giving us such a wonderful platform to tell our stories through materials around us that we seem to ignore. thank you also to our wonderful facilitators Mr. Yusuf, who led the way with such wisdom, Miss Caroline and Mr. Temitope, who also poured out themselves to everyone of the participants. to all the artists, I am so honored to have been part of such a talented and supportive team.

SURVIVAL SPOON

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



**Abduljabbar
Hasheem Saidu**

+234 909 681 7378



This experience opened my eyes to the possibilities of using art as a solution for environmental challenges. The Upcycle Workshop helped me explore how discarded materials can be transformed into meaningful creations through creativity, collaboration, and innovation. The practical sessions and shared knowledge strengthened my understanding of recycling, waste reduction, and the role artists can play in encouraging positive environmental change.

My artistic philosophy is centered on the idea that art goes beyond personal expression — it can educate, inspire, and create awareness in society. I believe materials considered as waste can be given new value and purpose through imagination. I sincerely appreciate the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery, partner organizations, and the facilitators for creating this platform that encouraged learning, growth, and the use of art to promote a more sustainable future.

THE ONLY ADDRESS

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



**Jesse Ojatta
Ameje**

+234 813 913 6320



The 5 Days Upcycle Art Workshop became a powerful reminder of my purpose as an artist to transform ideas, create connections, and use creativity to imagine a better future. The experience was filled with collaboration, inspiration, and meaningful interactions with fellow artists. The support, patience, and guidance from the facilitators contributed greatly to my growth and made me a better artist.

My artwork titled “Treasure” is a call to value and protect our environment. Created from discarded fabrics, Coca-Cola cans, plastics, and PVC packing strips, the piece shows that materials we often ignore can be transformed into something valuable and beautiful. I deeply appreciate the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery, the partners, and the facilitators for creating this platform that promotes sustainability, creativity, and environmental awareness.

THE TREASURE FOUND

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



Kaynan Peter

+234 810 615 1361



I am sincerely grateful to the Royal Norwegian Embassy for initiating the upcycling workshop themed “There Is No Planet B.” I also extend my appreciation to Chief Nike Monica Okundaye for graciously providing Nike Art Gallery as the host venue, creating an inspiring environment for creativity and collaboration. My heartfelt thanks go to Mr. Yusuf Durodola and his co-facilitators, Caroline and Mr. Temitope, whose guidance and mentorship greatly enriched the entire experience. I also acknowledge the efforts of Kaycee and Abdullahi for ensuring smooth coordination throughout the programme.

The workshop reshaped my perspective on both materials and people, teaching me the value of inclusion and the beauty of transformation. It inspired my artwork “Adorn Her,” which reflects how diverse elements can come together to create something meaningful and beautiful. Using discarded materials collected from different communities, I was reminded that collaboration and shared effort can produce extraordinary results. The experience strengthened my belief in creativity as a bridge between sustainability, community, and human connection.

ADORN HER, GRASS TO GRACE

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



Ngozi Akande (PhD)

+234 803 717 0531

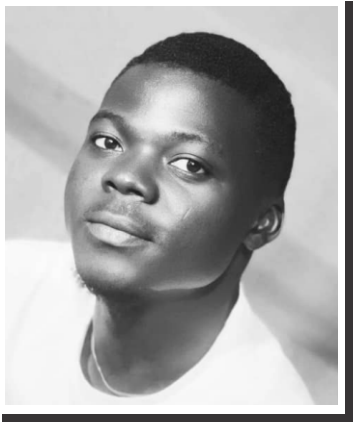


This workshop marked a turning point in how I relate to found objects in my mixed media practice. Although I have long worked with discarded materials, I previously lacked a structured understanding of how to transform them into intentional artistic elements. Through guided sessions and practical experimentation, I gained new skills and perspectives that have strengthened my ability to integrate these materials more thoughtfully and creatively into my work.

My piece, “Stars Everywhere,” reflects a community shaped by uncertainty, yet filled with hidden potential and untapped talent. It speaks to the idea that within challenging environments lie opportunities for growth when individuals are supported and empowered. I am sincerely grateful to the Royal Norwegian Embassy for sponsoring the workshop and to Nike Art Gallery for providing a nurturing creative space. Special appreciation goes to Mr. Yusuf, Mr. Temitope, Caroline, Katurag Chinyo, Abdullahi, and the media team for their dedication, guidance, and support throughout the programme.

STARRS EVERYWHERE

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



Ahmed Michael

+234 701 409 3013



The “Because There Is No Planet B” Upcycling Workshop provided a meaningful introduction to sustainable art practices and environmental responsibility. Through hands-on sessions, I learned how discarded materials can be reimagined into expressive artworks, while gaining a deeper awareness of the environmental impact of waste. The facilitators also enriched the experience by sharing their knowledge and creative approaches.

My artwork, “Man and His Environment,” uses discarded foam and plastics to explore the close relationship between humans and the environment, showing how human actions shape and define the world we live in. I sincerely appreciate the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery, Mr. Yusuf Durodola, Ms. Caroline, facilitators, and partners for making this workshop impactful and inspiring.

MAN, AND HIS ENVIRONMENT

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



**Sadiq Abimbola
Rukayat**

+234 813 633 5496



Working with unexpected materials during the Upcycle Workshop encouraged me to explore beyond my usual creative process and embrace spontaneity. The experience of creating alongside other artists revealed the beauty of shared ideas and different perspectives coming together. It challenged me to see discarded materials not as limitations, but as opportunities for new forms of artistic expression.

My artwork reflects the idea that human experiences are made up of different moments, choices, and challenges that come together to shape who we become. By transforming acrylic waste peels and discarded nylons into a unified composition, I highlight the journey of self-discovery, growth, and transformation. I am grateful to the Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery, and the facilitators Mr. Yusuf Durodola, Mr. Temitope Oladeji, and Miss Caroline Useh for their guidance, encouragement, and contribution to this creative experience.

THE SUM OF US

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



Joel Friday

+234 906 117 7367



The 5 Days Upcycle Art Workshop was a beautiful experience that helped me discover new possibilities in my art practice. I found inspiration in the materials provided, especially transforming carton into a house and using discarded fabrics from tailors' waste to create my work. My artwork, titled "Safe House," represents a clean and peaceful environment where everyone feels protected. It highlights the importance of keeping our surroundings beautiful and free from waste.

I appreciate the knowledge and guidance received from Mr. Durodola, Ms. Caroline, and Mr. Temitope, which has greatly influenced my growth as an artist. I am grateful to Nike Art Gallery for hosting the programme and to the Royal Norwegian Embassy for sponsoring this impactful workshop. This experience has encouraged me to continue developing my creative practice.

SAFE HOUSE

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



Samuel Ilori

+234 806 793 2661



Participating in the 5 Days Upcycle Art Workshop exposed me to the creative possibilities of turning discarded materials into valuable works of art. The experience showed me how waste materials can be transformed into pieces that inspire people while also helping to address environmental challenges caused by pollution. My artwork titled “A Call to Build Our Nation” reflects the different roles people play in society — those contributing to progress and those affecting development negatively.

Through the use of waste whiteboard marker refill plastics, slippers, and plastic strips, I created a piece that encourages unity and responsibility towards building a better nation. I believe that the efforts of those working for positive change are stronger, and this artwork serves as a reminder for everyone to contribute to a cleaner and peaceful environment. I am grateful to the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Chief Mrs. Nike Okundaye, Nike Art Gallery, and the facilitators for making this workshop possible.

A CALL TO BUILD

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



**Olowa Emmanuel
Akorede**

+234 903 505 9019



MAI KAYAN MARMARI

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026

Reuniting with fellow artists from the Zaria Art School — Abimbola, Aisha, and Naomie — added a familiar and enriching layer to my experience, while also meeting new creatives who shared an instant artistic connection with me. The workshop combined dialogue with hands-on practice, allowing us to translate theory into tangible outcomes. We explored the business of art, the philosophical dimensions of artistic practice, and how to navigate transitions as contemporary artists. Key insights included Mr. Temitope's emphasis on collaboration over competition, Mr. Yusuf's teachings on humanism, love, and generosity in artistic communities, and Ms. Caroline's guidance on choosing supportive environments and maintaining healthy creative relationships.

My artwork emerges as an advocacy for Northern Nigeria, challenging negative media narratives that often misrepresent the region. It highlights the resilience and productivity of its people through the imagery of a man

pushing a wheel of fruits, symbolizing labour, abundance, and overlooked potential. The work raises a reflective question about national responsibility that is, if one region is neglected, the impact is collective. I extend my sincere appreciation to the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery, all facilitators, coordinators, studio assistants, and fellow artists whose presence, support, and shared energy made the experience both meaningful and memorable.



**Buhari Sani
Junaid**

+234 802 955 5456



Over the course of five days, the Upcycle Art Workshop became an immersive space of discovery where environmental awareness and artistic experimentation merged. The collaborative setting brought together artists from different backgrounds, creating an atmosphere of exchange, experimentation, and shared learning. Engaging directly with discarded materials reshaped my understanding of waste, strengthening my commitment to using art as a medium for environmental reflection and advocacy.

My artwork, "Garbage to Grace," responds to the urgent message of "Because There Is No Planet B" by transforming waste into a visual narrative of survival and renewal. The composition features a hand emerging from discarded materials, symbolising humanity's fragile relationship with the environment and the possibility of recovery through conscious action. A butterfly resting on the finger represents transformation and hope, while green elements suggest regeneration and the restorative power of nature. The work reimagines waste not as an end, but as a beginning for dialogue, creativity, and environmental responsibility. I remain deeply grateful to the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery, facilitators, and partners for making this transformative experience possible.

GARBAGE TO GRACE

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



Mbaya Aisha

+234 818 065 7958



This workshop created a space for me to explore the connection between creativity, environmental responsibility, and advocacy. The opportunity to work independently with discarded materials allowed me to push the boundaries of my artistic practice and discover new ways of expressing ideas through form and texture. Every day of the 5 Days Upcycle Art Workshop brought inspiration, experimentation, and a deeper appreciation for transforming waste into meaningful art.

My artwork celebrates the strength, struggles, and hope of the northern Nigerian woman. Using fractured CD discs, a discarded dustbin leather bag, carton, and melted plastic bottles, I transformed waste into a powerful representation of resilience and beauty. The piece reflects the balance between vulnerability and strength, while showing how discarded materials can carry new meaning. I am grateful to the Royal Norwegian Embassy, Nike Art Gallery, and the facilitators whose support helped create this impactful platform for environmental awareness through art.

GWARZO

Discarded items assemblage
61cm by 61cm, 2026



Caroline Useh



Caroline Useh, is a multidisciplinary artist from Delta state based in Lagos Nigeria. She creates her works with no restrictions to media. Her distinctive works explores the use of materials as mixed media, an alternative to painting. Caroline's works, explores awakening for a mental reformation, emotional relearning, cautioning identity crisis, restructuring unhealthy memories, advocating to be humanly before gender differences, submitting to fluidity and flow of a moment .

Her practice is a place to unwind, educate, advocate, protest, project, question, challenge, provoke and address behavioral actions. Caroline was the winner of the Chinwe Russell Awards Art prize 2025. She was one of the finalist at the Kuenyahia Art competition and exhibition Ghana, 2024.

In 2023, she was one of the ten finalists of Next of Kin Series 5, an annual juried art competition and exhibition.

TOMORROW

Cotton bias tapes on canvas/ board
61cm by 61cm, 2026



**Yusuf
Durodola**



Yusuf Durodola is an integrative multimedia upcycling art specialist dedicated to transforming hazardous discarded materials into meaningful works that address environmental challenges and promote sustainability.

His distinctive concepts and visual language stem from a deep understanding of human negligence and unsustainable manufacturing practices. Through careful selection and refinement of waste materials, whose “souls” he believes still possess value, he creates mixed media and assemblage pieces that has a diverse dimensional forms.

Using the natural colors and textures inherent in these reclaimed materials, Yusuf constructs images, reliefs, and ornamental compositions that rhetorically challenge society's negligence toward waste management and encourage a more responsible relationship with the environment.

TOP UP

Discarded items assemblage
and ink on board
61cm by 61cm, 2026































PANEL

DISCUSSION



MODERATOR



Temitope Oladeji

*Project Lead,
The Art Exential.*

Temitope Oladeji is an astute Arts Project Coordinator, a specialist in curating and commissioning Art for variety of projects. Temitope has a cross-sector expertise in Brand Activation and Events Management for Nike, Swatch, BATC, Bet9ja, Dangote Industries and ATC Nigeria, amongst others.

With experience spanning almost a decade, in 2020, he founded The Art Exential, a 360-degree art firm with core offerings in Art Advisory, Art Collection Management, Art installation/Restoration, Art Valuation, Art Project Management, Producing Solo and Group shows.

Having Established a trusted reputation within the Arts sector and the Elite community, Temitope professional experience of working directly on several projects gives him an exceeding rare insight. Into the artistic standards and tastes of the high-net-worth clients and an intimate understanding of what it takes to bring the best to clients.



Ikechi Chris Ebuka

Programs Officer, Plogging Nigeria

Ikechi Chris Ebuka is a Business Development Manager, Brand Strategist, and Sustainability Advocate with a strong focus on advancing sustainable development through innovation, strategic partnerships, and community engagement. His work sits at the intersection of business growth, environmental sustainability, and social impact.

He has professional experience spanning fintech, business development, market research, stakeholder engagement, and data-driven strategy, where he supports organizations in identifying growth opportunities, improving decision-making, and building impactful partnerships.

Beyond his corporate career, Chris is actively engaged in environmental and sustainability initiatives. He serves as a Programs Leader with Plogging Nigeria and has played a key role in niwad.ng, a platform that connects recycling, upcycling, and waste management service providers across Nigeria. Through this and other initiatives such as the Green Switch Academy, he contributes to designing and implementing youth-focused programs on climate action, sustainability, and leadership development.

His work reflects a strong commitment to the circular economy and waste-to-value innovation, with a focus on enabling communities and businesses to transform environmental challenges into opportunities for sustainable economic and social impact.

Chris believes that meaningful environmental progress requires collaboration across government, private sector, creatives, and communities. He remains committed to building solutions that drive sustainability, empower people, and create lasting impacts.



Zainab Mustapha Umara

*Assistant Director, Environmental Quality
Control NESREA, Headquarters, Abuja*

Zainab Mustapha Umara is an environmental professional serving as an Assistant Director in the Environmental Quality Control Department. BSc Geology and MSc Environmental Engineering.

Her work focuses on air quality control, greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions mitigation, ozone layer protection, environmental compliance monitoring, and enforcement of environmental standards. She contributes to initiatives that support climate action, pollution prevention, and the implementation of national and international environmental commitments.



Christianah Imoleayo Owoeye

*Chief Executive Officer
Trash Monger Limited*

Christianah Imoleayo Owoeye is the Chief Executive Officer of Trash Monger Limited, a social enterprise dedicated to transforming waste into value while creating sustainable livelihoods for women and young people. Through innovative recycling, waste collection, environmental education, and circular economy initiatives, Trash Monger has diverted over 6,500 tonnes of waste from the environment and empowered hundreds of individuals through green skills and income-generating opportunities.

Christianah is an environmental sustainability advocate, social entrepreneur, and fellow of several leadership and impact-driven programs across Africa. She is passionate about building inclusive, community-driven solutions that promote responsible consumption, environmental stewardship, and economic empowerment.

Trash Monger Limited is a Nigerian recycling and circular economy enterprise committed to creating cleaner communities and sustainable livelihoods through waste recovery, recycling, upcycling, and environmental education. The organization works with households, businesses, schools, and communities to promote responsible waste management while transforming recyclable materials into valuable resources and products. Through its innovative programs and community-based initiatives, Trash Monger is advancing a circular economy that benefits both people and the planet.



Yusuf Durodola

*Creative Director YD Studio
and Trash To Treasure Movement*

Yusuf Durodola is a distinguished Nigerian visual artist, researcher, educator, and multidisciplinary creative whose practice encompasses painting, recycled art, performance, curatorial projects, and art education. He is a Guinness World Record achiever for the Largest Painting by Number created for École de Dessin, Lagos, Nigeria.

He currently serves as a Painting Lecturer at the Federal College of Education (Technical), Akoka, and is the Founder and Artistic Director of the Artegun Foundation, a platform committed to nurturing emerging artists, advancing curatorial practice, and promoting art through innovative and transformative experiences.

Widely recognized for his thought-provoking recycled art, deeply reflective conversational paintings, inspiring performance art, and outstanding contributions to curatorial and creative direction, Durodola has established himself as one of the leading multimedia visual artists of his generation. His works are distinguished by their conceptual depth and their engagement with issues of environmental sustainability, human behavior, social consciousness, and cultural identity.

Through a career that bridges artistic practice, scholarship, and community engagement, Yusuf Durodola continues to shape contemporary Nigerian art while inspiring a new generation of creatives through mentorship, education, and innovative artistic interventions.



About the Royal Norwegian Embassy in Nigeria

The Royal Norwegian Embassy in Nigeria serves as the official representation of the Kingdom of Norway, dedicated to strengthening the longstanding relationship between Norway and Nigeria. Rooted in mutual respect and shared values, the Embassy works to advance cooperation across key areas including energy, maritime affairs, economic development, governance, climate action, and cultural exchange.

With a strong commitment to partnership, the Embassy plays a central role in fostering dialogue and collaboration between Norwegian and Nigerian institutions, businesses, and communities. It supports initiatives that promote sustainable development, innovation, and inclusive growth, reflecting Norway's global engagement priorities.

In celebration of World Environment Day, the Embassy embraces the power of art as a tool for environmental awareness and advocacy. By engaging artists, communities, and institutions, it promotes creative expression that inspires action, sparks dialogue and highlights the urgent need to protect our planet.

The Royal Norwegian Embassy remains committed to contributing positively to Nigeria's development journey while strengthening ties between both nations for a shared and sustainable future.



NIKE ART FOUNDATION

Nike Art Foundation, founded and led by Chief Mrs. Nike Monica Okundaye, is a world-renowned institution dedicated to artistic education, cultural preservation, and creative empowerment.

Established in 1983 in Osogbo, Nigeria, the Foundation has provided free training and mentorship to hundreds of aspiring artists and craftspeople, equipping them with valuable skills in painting, wood sculpture, relief carving, beadwork, mosaic, batik, adire, appliqué, quilting, pen and ink drawing, drum making, dance, and other traditional and contemporary art forms.

What makes the Foundation truly unique is its commitment to teaching and presenting art in continuity with indigenous African culture and traditions. By preserving ancestral knowledge and nurturing new generations of creative talents, the Nike Art Foundation continues to inspire artistic excellence and foster cultural pride across communities.

Nike Art Foundation, Preserving Heritage,
Empowering Creativity, Inspiring Generations.

PERFORMANCEART

ÒDÀLÈDÀ'LÈ: YOUR CELEBRATION WILL NOT GO UNRETURNED

YUSUF DURODOLA

CO-PERFORMERS:

CAROLINE USEH

JESSE OJATTA AMEJE

OLOWA EMMANUEL AKOREDE

SHEDRACH GABRIEL

CURATED BY **TEMITOPE OLADEJI**

Òdàlè Dà'lè is a Yoruba expression meaning “he who litters the land is a betrayer of the land.” The performance examines humanity’s careless relationship with the environment, confronting the culture of waste disposal and environmental neglect. Through symbolic actions and spatial intervention, the work presents the earth as a living witness that bears the consequences of human actions.

ÒDÀLÈ DÀ'LÈ transforms space into a site of reflection and reckoning, reminding us that whatever is repeatedly poured onto the land eventually returns to its source. It is a call for environmental responsibility and a reminder that respect for the earth must be reciprocal.

WORLD ENVIRONMENTAL DAY:

05062026

NIKEARTGALLERYABUJA

PHOTO CREDIT:
BENJAMIN OLADAPO

